

**VMware Global Inc.**

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Letter of Reference

Mr. Markus Klein was employed in our company from 1 September 2014 to 30 June 2025 as a Senior Manager, End-User Field Applications.

VMware is driving the world's digital infrastructure with its business software. The company's solutions in the areas of data center, cloud, mobility, network and security offer a flexible and efficient basis for business success and allow already more than 500,000 customers to benefit. The comprehensive portfolio is distributed by a global network of 75,000 partners. The company, headquartered in California's Silicon Valley, celebrated its twenty-fifth anniversary and numerous groundbreaking innovations in 2023. The German office is located in Munich.

During the employment with the company, Mr. Markus Klein's key job responsibilities include the following:

Regional Executive Leader, Solutions Engineering EMEA

VMware by Broadcom | Nov 1st, 2023 – Jun 30, 2025| EMEA Partner & Commercial Solutions

- Initiation of new EMEA solution engineering organization of more than 30 people
- Established the team structure, job descriptions, market coverage model while ensuring morale at high level
- Set KPI's and Reporting structure and dashboard for team
- Maintained contribution to the regional pipeline through specific activities like webinars and workshops
- Led the team to achieve 200% of the revenue target in the first fiscal year following the rebuild, thereby reestablishing collaboration with channel partner and commercial customers
- Definition of solution packages to enable partners' sales execution
- Definition and execution of workshops for key customers
- Senior member of the EMEA leadership team for the Partner & Commercial division, played a key role in aligning the go-to-market strategy with regional sales targets and competitive positioning
- Motivated and empowered the partner ecosystem to operate independently within the new Broadcom environment and successfully implement the agreed-upon strategy and execution

Senior Director, Solutions Engineering Central Europe

VMware | Sept 1st, 2014 – Oct 31, 2023| DACH, Eastern Europe, Russia, Israel

- Technical and managerial leadership of the solution engineering organization for the Central Europe region

- Grew the team from an initial 60 to over 180 employees, including more than 20 Solution Engineering Managers under direct and dotted-line supervision
- Independently responsible for planning and managing the regional personnel budget
- Career Planning, promotions and succession planning for Individuals and managers
- Closely working with regional and EMEA leadership to drive business via existing matrix organisation
- Initiating and implementation of EMEA-wide career development program for all solution engineers, the Career Development System Framework
- Established EMEA-wide subject matter expert teams covering product, solution, and vertical market topics
- Maintained direct contact and sponsorship relationships with most important customers in the CEMEA region
- Developed custom customer workshops using design thinking methods, focused on VMware solution areas, thereby establishing new sales approaches
- Played a significant role in the CEMEA region's above-average growth

(>10% YoY)

- Created and fostered a high-performing corporate culture with an exceptionally low turnover rate of less than 5% in a highly competitive job market for presales professionals.
- Served as an executive officer ("Leitender Angestellter") as defined by German law

Mr. Klein possesses excellent in-depth specialist knowledge even in peripheral fields, which he always applied to our business processes in a most effective and beneficial manner. He continuously and very successfully expanded and updated his extensive specialist knowledge to the benefit of our company by regularly attending events to further his education.

Due to his very good perception, he was always able to understand complex situations immediately and to find very good solutions straight away. Mr. Klein always worked using his own initiative and completely identified with his responsibilities and our company at all times. He always displayed an impressive level of dedication and motivation. In extremely stressful situations, he always displayed exemplary resilience.

He always completed his tasks completely independently, extremely carefully and according to a well thought-out plan. He worked calmly, thoughtfully, in a target-oriented manner and extremely precisely at all times. He continuously impressed us particularly in terms of quality and quantity. Mr. Klein always was extremely reliable.

He was always able to find excellent solutions for any problems which arose. Due to his excellent leadership qualities, he was a highly respected and popular line manager. His attitude towards colleagues was always open and friendly, but he also knew how to assert himself in difficult situations and how to motivate staff to excellent performance. The performance of Mr Klein always earned our full recognition in every respect.

He was respected by everyone for his consistently friendly and well-balanced demeanour. He was always helpful, courteous, and if necessary, he put the interests of others before his own. His personal conduct towards his line managers, colleagues and clients was always exemplary and loyal.

Mr. Klein will be leaving our company on 30 June 2025. We sincerely regret his departure, as we will be losing a very capable employee. We would like to thank him for his consistently excellent performance and wish him all the best and every success in his future professional career and private life.

München, 30 June 2025

VMware Global Inc., Zweigniederlassung Deutschland

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Susanne Vaih', with a stylized flourish at the end.

Susanne Vaih
HR Business Partner, Germany & Austria